SHADYNASTY LEAGUE OFFICE

OFFICE OF THE COMMISSIONER • DEPARTMENT OF COMPETITIVE INTEGRITY

Est. 2021 • "Trades will not be vetoed, except in clear cases of collusion."

Shoebeer Enforcement Division

October 21, 2026

NO MERCY

VIA SHADYNASTY LEAGUE CHAT
Mr. Joe Morehouse (a/k/a "joebags85")
Owner, Rebuilding Morehouse's (f/k/a Tankin4trinidad)
Co-Commissioner, SHADYNASTY League
and New Counsel (identity unknown, licensure unverified)

RE: OMNIBUS RULING ON RESPONDENT'S AMENDED FILING, WITH STATEMENT OF UNDISPUTED FACTS, MEMORANDUM OF LAW, AND ORDERS, Matter No. SHADY-2026-001.03

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (a/k/a TL;DR, for the Executive Council)

- **Same confession, new lawyer.** "I do not dispute the factual roster moves listed in Exhibit A." Twice.
- **Estoppel.** He committed in writing, then said "Disregard my previous statement." The Consent Agreement stands.
- **Zero precedent.** He was handed 47 no-show starts (only 2 his) and still named none.
- **"I will continue with my current plan"** is an admission that the conduct is ongoing.
- **Potential Points** protect bad luck, not engineering. Argument rejected.
- **Orders:** Shoebeer audit from Week 7, the rookie pick is officially on notice, and acknowledge by Thursday night kickoff.

Everything below is the receipts.

Dear Mr. Morehouse:

The League Office acknowledges your amended filing, posted to the league chat with the words "I have fired my previous counsel. Disregard my previous statement." Our condolences to your former counsel. You have asked for the heavy hitters. The League Office has retained them. They do not do mercy, and they bill in shoeys.

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I. Statement of Undisputed Facts

The following facts are drawn from the Respondent's own filings and the official Sleeper record. None is disputed. Most were typed by the Respondent himself.

1. On October 21, 2026, the Respondent's franchise added five players from free agency, every one of them on IR or PUP. (Notice SHADY-2026-001.01, Exhibit A.)
2. In his original filing, the Respondent wrote: "I do not dispute the factual roster moves listed in Exhibit A."
3. In the same filing, he committed, beginning with Week 7, to "Construct starting lineups using only players reasonably expected to participate in at least one snap that week" and to "Cease any pattern of acquiring injured players whose sole apparent purpose is reduction of Potential Points".
4. He then posted: "I have fired my previous counsel. Disregard my previous statement."
5. His amended filing again states: "I do not dispute the factual roster moves listed in Exhibit A."
6. The amended filing states: "I do not agree to the compliance demands set forth in your letter."
7. The amended filing states: "Moving forward, I will continue with my current plan of roster management."
8. The amended filing describes that plan as including "evaluating free-agent additions—including currently injured or limited players—on the basis of long-term dynasty value and the realities of available talent."
9. The amended filing is captioned "VIA SLEEPER DIRECT MESSAGE." It was posted in the league chat.

II. Same Confession, New Lawyer (*Admissions Against Interest*)

Under the doctrine of *admissions against interest*, a statement a party makes against his own position is given special weight, because nobody says that kind of thing by accident. The Respondent has now said it twice, under two different lawyers. Facts 2 and 5 are identical, word for word. You fired your counsel and kept his confession. That is not a change of strategy. That is a change of letterhead. Exhibit A stands.

III. Service of Process

The amended filing claims service "VIA SLEEPER DIRECT MESSAGE." It was posted in the league chat, in front of everyone (Fact 9). New counsel's first sentence of record is a factual error about where he is standing. Service is accepted anyway, out of pity, and because the League Office does not need technicalities to win this one.

IV. Estoppel: The Disappearing Commitments

The doctrine of *estoppel* prevents a party from making a promise, letting others rely on it, and then taking it back when it becomes inconvenient. In his original filing the Respondent made specific written commitments to the full league (Fact 3). The League Office relied on them and entered them as a Consent Agreement in Notice SHADY-2026-001.02. The Respondent now says "Disregard my previous statement" and "I do not agree to the compliance demands set forth in your letter" (Facts 4 and 6).

The Respondent is **estopped**. A manager cannot sign a deal in the group chat and then void it by firing the guy who typed it. If that worked, every trade in this league would come with a lawyer. The Consent Agreement stands.

V. Still No Precedent

The Respondent's amended filing still claims the league "previously tolerated, and in some cases openly celebrated, tanking strategies that produced similarly depressed Potential Points without formal sanction." It still names no example.

The League Office already did that research for him. Notice SHADY-2026-001.02 identified 47 regular-season starts from 2021 to 2025 (Weeks 1–14) where the player never took the field: 43 inactive, injured or not on an NFL team, and 4 on a bye. Only 2 were the Respondent's. The leading authorities are as follows:

- In re joebags85, 2023 Shady. Rptr. Wk. 14 (SHADYNASTY 2023). Respondent started C.J. Beathard and Aaron Jones. Neither took the field. No notice issued. Held: a manager who forgot two guys in Week 14 was bad at this, which is not a violation.
- In re DetroitDumpsterFires, 2025 Shady. Rptr. Wk. 14 (SHADYNASTY 2025). Manager started Jaxson Dart and Devin Singletary during the Giants' bye week. Held: not reading the schedule is a personal failing, not a scheme.
- In re ElJefe1985, 2024 Shady. Rptr. Wk. 12 (SHADYNASTY 2024). Manager started Joe Burrow on Cincinnati's bye. Held: see above.

Each of those is one bad week by one distracted manager. None involved five unavailable players added in one day, followed by two written filings defending it. The Respondent's precedents are not precedents. They are alibis for other people.

VI. The Plan Is Ongoing (*Res Ipsa Loquitur*)

Res ipsa loquitur: the thing speaks for itself. Here, the thing also typed a letter. The Respondent writes: "Moving forward, I will continue with my current plan of roster management" (Fact 7). Exhibit A is the current plan. A promise to continue it is an **admission that the conduct is ongoing**.

The Respondent also promises to "field lineups that reflect the actual state of my roster." Agreed. They will. The Respondent put the roster in that state on purpose, and has now described the method in writing (Fact 8). "My lineup is full of injured players because I filled my roster with injured players" is not a defense. It is a recipe.

> *§ Lineups: "Each team must start players who are reasonably expected to play at least one snap in an NFL game that week."*
>
> *§ Lineups: "Each owner is expected to make an honest attempt at starting their most optimal valid lineup for each week of the season."*

VII. Ruling on Potential Points (Canons of Construction)

The Respondent argues: "The Bylaws establish Potential Points as the intentional mechanism for assessing team quality for draft order." He adds: "Managing a roster in a manner that results in lower Potential Points is not “intentional sabotage”; it is a foreseeable and previously accepted outcome of the system the league chose." The relevant text:

> *§ Tanking: "Draft order for non-playoff teams is determined by inverse of end of season optimal/potential points to assess true value/quality of teams."*
> *§ Tanking: "Potential points are based on if teams had started their optimal lineup every week."*

The League Office applies three canons of construction.

A. Plain meaning. The rule says what Potential Points are for: "to assess true value/quality of teams." True value. Not manufactured value, and not value you hid on IR to bring back in 2028.

B. Purpose. The league ranks non-playoff teams by what they could have scored instead of their record so that an *unlucky* team, one that lost close games or ran into somebody's career week, is not punished in the draft. The rule exists to protect bad luck. It does not reward engineering. The Bylaws state their own purpose, which is to "ensure a fair and fun league for all owners." A plan to hand yourself the 1.01 by building a roster that cannot score is many things. Fair to all owners is not one of them.

C. No absurd results. A rule should not be read in a way that produces an absurd result. Under the Respondent's reading, the best possible strategy for a non-playoff team is to roster nothing but injured players and start them every week, and that would be "a foreseeable and previously accepted outcome of the system." A rule designed to measure true team quality cannot also be a rule that rewards fielding no team. The Respondent's reading is **rejected**.

VIII. The Executive Council

The Respondent reserves "the right to challenge any selective enforcement or inconsistent application of the rules with the full league or Executive Council." The league has no Executive Council. The full league is the group chat. The Executive Council is the group chat. The Respondent filed there. Consider yourself heard. Appeals from the Executive Council may be taken to the Executive Council.

IX. Anticipated Arguments, Pre-Rebutted

In the interest of judicial economy, and of everybody's group chat notifications, the League Office pre-rebuts the next filing.

1. **"The Bylaws don't explicitly ban this."** The Bylaws anticipated you: "If a rule is not explicitly stated, the commissioners will be responsible for interpreting these criteria and new rules will be subsequently documented in these bylaws."
2. **"Everyone does it."** See Section V. Forty-seven in five seasons across the whole league, only 2 yours. Everyone does not do it. Everyone forgets. You planned.
3. **"The players have dynasty upside."** Upside is not a snap. The Bylaws ask whether a starter is "reasonably expected to play at least one snap in an NFL game that week," not whether he might be decent in 2028.
4. **"I'm a Co-Commissioner, so this is a conflict."** Correct. You are claiming selective enforcement by an office you co-run. If the League Office singled you out, you helped.
5. **"I fired my counsel again."** Noted in advance. See Section IV. The confession travels with the client.

X. Orders

1. The **Consent Agreement** from Notice SHADY-2026-001.02 stands. Firing your counsel does not void it.
2. The **Shoebeer Compliance Audit** begins in Week 7, with a lineup review every week. Any breach earns a ceremonial shoey, on video, posted to the group chat.
3. **Escalation.** If the audit finds a Week 7 or later starter who is not reasonably expected to play a snap, the League Office will treat it as a second offense under the Owner Responsibilities penalty schedule:

> *"2nd offense or more severe incident: Loss of earliest owned rookie pick (e.g. 1st round) and forfeit the right to any prize winnings for the season."*

This is mostly in jest. Mostly. Nobody is taking anything today. But the rookie pick is now **officially on notice**. It has been informed of its rights, it has been told not to leave town, and it has asked for a lawyer. We told it the Respondent might have a spare.

The Respondent shall acknowledge this ruling in the league chat by kickoff of the Thursday night game. Govern yourself accordingly, and for the love of God, start somebody who is going to play.

Exhibits

A	Notice SHADY-2026-001.01, Exhibit A: free agent additions of October 21, 2026 (undisputed, twice)
B	Respondent's original filing, SHADY-2026-001.01-R (superseded by the Respondent; commitments survive)
C	Respondent's amended filing, SHADY-2026-001.01-R2 ("I will continue with my current plan")
D	Notice SHADY-2026-001.02 (Consent Agreement; the 47)
E	SHADYNASTY League Bylaws, §§ Lineups, Tanking, Owner Conduct & Responsibilities
F	Official Sleeper matchup records, 2021–2025 regular seasons

Respectfully submitted,

Brett Wilson

Brett Wilson, Co-Commissioner
SHADYNASTY League Office

Of Counsel:

The Shoebeer Enforcement Division (admitted to practice in the group chat only)	Snap Count & Associates (Reasonably Expected to Appear)
Potential, Points & Optimal LLP (Specialists in What You Could Have Scored)	Office of the Injury Report (Appearing Questionable, Expected to Play)

cc: The Full League (Sleeper chat), a/k/a the Executive Council

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This letter is a league communication, not legal advice, and is issued in the spirit of the Bylaws' Conduct provision: "Trash talking and shit-posting are actively encouraged." The "Shady. Rptr." citations refer to real games in the official Sleeper records of this league and to no real court. The precedent figures are those reported in Notice SHADY-2026-001.02 (official Sleeper records, 2021–2025 regular seasons; whether a player took the field is based on Sleeper weekly NFL stats).